

ROCK PAPER PROMISE

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December 8th, 2022
WRIT 318 (A01)
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FADE IN:

EXT. MR.HOTSHOT'S VILE VEGAS CASINO - PARKING LOT - NIGHT

The parking lot is empty.

It stretches toward the Casino's front entrance.

REVOLVING DOORS turn around and around.

A large SIGN is plastered on the building:

A picture of a greasy old man, donning a cigar and tinted-aviators. He shoots finger guns at the viewer.

"FOR LEASE - Call MR.HOTSHOT - (555-777-7777)."

Out from the doors walks the very same man. An old-school gambling legend turned resident douche-bag: It's MR.HOTSHOT (77).

He impatiently fumbles his KEYS in the door lock.

The KEYS slip out of his hands. They hit the concrete.

MR.HOTSHOT

(sigh)

'Heeeeeeeeere we fuckin' go.

Hotshot readies his back for the impending bend.

He stretches down for the keys...

...A shadowy figure looms from BEHIND.

PACHINKO VALENTINE

Might these be your--

MR.HOTSHOT

WHAT IN TH'--

Hotshot FALLS to the pavement.

Before him stands the eccentric, devilish, and sharply-dressed PACHINKO VALENTINE (50s).

He jingles Hotshot's KEYS.

MR.HOTSHOT

Who the hell are you!?

Valentine extends a hand to Hotshot.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Pachinko Valentine. A pleasure.

They shake hands.

Valentine helps Hotshot to his feet.

Hotshot looks him up and down.

MR.HOTSHOT
Why d'you look dressed for a
fuckin' funeral?

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Always be ready and dressed for a
funeral. You simply never know when
you'll be in attendance.

Valentine tosses Hotshot the keys.

MR.HOTSHOT
Keep loiterin' on my property and
it's gonna be yours.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
The property?

MR.HOTSHOT
The funeral!

PACHINKO VALENTINE
But your sign, my good sir!

Valentine points to the FOR LEASE SIGN above.

A pause.

MR.HOTSHOT
...BAH-HAH-HAH-HAH!
(wheeze)
Yer buyin', huh? What kinda snow-
nosed shit is this?

Hotshot aggressively sniffs the Casino's outer walls.

MR.HOTSHOT
You smell that, boy!? That's the
smell of more money than your whole
life's savings! You either gimme
fifty-mil', or you get the fuck
out!

PACHINKO VALENTINE
I'm afraid I lack the desired
funds.

Hotshot pulls out a GUN.

MR.HOTSHOT
Then it's time to get the fuck out.

Silence.

Boom. Boom. Boom. Boom.

BOOM. BOOM. BOOM. BOOM.

The BEAT of a tacky club mix grows near.

SCREEEEECH!

A LIMO swerves into the PARKING LOT — filled with enough
party-goers and woo-girls to put Hugh Hefner to shame.

MR.HOTSHOT
(to Valentine)
Lucky you. M'ride's here.

TWEAKED-OUT PARTYGOER #1
Ayyyy! It's the hotshot!

TWEAKED-OUT PARTYGOER #2
Get in, man! Come on!

Hotshot laughs his way to the limo.

MR.HOTSHOT
(to Valentine)
See 'ya never, 'ya loose-changed
limp-dick!

Hotshot reaches for the Limo Door HANDLE.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Nay.

The music STOPS.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
I dub thee limp-dick!

TWEAKED-OUT PARTYGOER #1
Yoooo! He just threw limp-dick back
at Hotshot!

TWEAKED-OUT PARTYGOER #2
This hasn't happened since the game
of '87!

Silence.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
(to Hotshot)
We're newly acquainted, and you
threaten my life?

Valentine holds up a COIN.

PACHINKO VALENTINE (CONT'D)
Let's make it interesting.

They stare eachother down.

TWEAKED-OUT PARTYGOER #1
Yoooo! Hotshot's gettin' called
out!

TWEAKED-OUT PARTYGOER #2
He's like, gonna come outta
retirement to spank this punk,
right?

TWEAKED-OUT PARTYGOER #1
Right!

Hotshot overhears this.

He stares at Valentine.

MR.HOTSHOT
(to Valentine)
I'm gonna make 'ya fold like a
house-a-cards!

PARTYGOERS
YEAHHHHH!!

PACHINKO VALENTINE
We aren't playing Poker, Hotshot.
(beat)
I'm sure this coin will suffice.

Valentine tosses the coin to Hotshot.

Hotshot inspects it.

Just an ordinary coin.

MR.HOTSHOT
'Yer more of a pussy than I
thought!

Valentine gets up close to Hotshot.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
If I win, the casino is mine.
(beat)
If you win, my soul is yours.

Silence.

Hotshot takes a deep breath.

MR.HOTSHOT
Call it.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Heads.

Hotshot throws the coin skyward!

Heads, Tails, Heads, Tails, Heads, Tails...

...It spins in the wind...

Heads, Tails, Heads, Tails, Heads, Tails...

...It strikes the concrete.

MR.HOTSHOT
WAH-HAH-HAH-HOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOO!!

Tails.

Like a man back his prime, Mr.Hotshot JUMPS FOR JOY.

He LAUGHS.

He WHEEZES.

Valentine kneels down. He picks up the coin.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
The outcome shines brightly upon
you, my friend.

MR.HOTSHOT
You must be some special kinda
stupid! This ain't a gamble with no
fuckin' rookie!

Hotshot slowly raises his GUN.

Valentine stares down the barrel.

Hotshot readies his aim.

It's shaky.

MR.HOTSHOT
(wheezing)
This...is what it means t'gamble...
...with the Hotshot!

He clutches his CHEST.

MR.HOTSHOT
(wheezing)
This...is...real gamblin'!

His EYES ROLL BACKWARD.

He FALLS to the PAVEMENT.

The GUN FLIES OUT of his HANDS.

It's about to hit the GROUND--

BANG!!

Silence.

Mr.Hotshot is DEAD. A tragic misfire.

The limo of party-goers floors it out of frame.

Blood streams toward Valentine's shoes.

He gently steps out of the way.

He unfolds a clean white handkerchief.

He picks up the blood-soaked KEYS.

He approaches the casino.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Indeed, Mr.Hotshot...

He unlocks the entrance.

PACHINKO VALENTINE (CONT'D)
...This is real gambling.

He pushes through the revolving doors.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. VALENTINE'S DIVINE CASINO - MAIN HALL - NIGHT

BAM!

Two players BURST through the REVOLVING DOORS.

Smokey, shaggy, and raggedy - it's the local and legendary gambling duo:

DARTS (Male, 30s), the eye-patched wildcard, and his best friend ROSHAMBO THE DOG (Male, 7).

ROSHAMBO

BORK!

Roshambo's bark echoes down the game-hall.

Slots STOP SPINNING.

Poker players FOLD.

The entire casino grinds to a HALT.

DARTS

Under new management, I see!

Darts holds the oversized Roshambo proudly in one arm.

Everyone stares.

DARTS (CONT'D)

'Heard old man Hotshot struck a
poor bet!

He puts Roshambo down.

He steps forward.

DARTS (CONT'D)

Sounds like there's a new top dog
in town.

The crowd keeps quiet.

DARTS (CONT'D)

You all know what I want.

Darts steps forward.

DARTS (CONT'D)

Bring me Pachinko Valentine!

From the other end of the game-hall, at the fanciest Poker table in the room...

...PACHINKO VALENTINE rises from his seat.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
I know not who you are, or from
where you have come, but allow me
to say that you, my friend, have
done the impossible.

Darts stares down Valentine.

PACHINKO VALENTINE (CONT'D)
You walk through my doors, and my
gamblers stop gambling.
(beat)
Quite the wild-card, aren't we?

DARTS
I'm the wildest there is.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Prove it.

Valentine tosses a COIN into the AIR.

Heads, Tails, Heads, Tails...

Darts is silent.

The COIN hits the floor.

DARTS
Really? Heads-or-tails?
(beat)
Let's play a real game.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Very well.

Valentine gives a gruesome grin...

...that slowly fades into a confused stare.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Um...What is he doing?

Darts turns around.

DARTS
ROSHY!

Roshambo walks aimless circles through the revolving doors.

His face smushes against the glass, propelling him forward.

Darts marches toward him.

DARTS
(under his breath)
'Gotta go and ruin our cool fuckin'
entrance...

He collects Roshambo.

Darts turns around.

DARTS
HOLY--

Valentine stands before him.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
And who might this be? Your lucky
paw?

DARTS
My partner.

Valentine gets down on one knee.

He stares into Roshambo's EYES.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Oh...These eyes...What a calm and
tranquil blue.
(beat)
Blissfully oblivious to the world
he lives in.
(beat)
Must be nice.

DARTS
This ain't the Westminster Dog
Show. Quit stalling.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Who's stalling? The game has begun.

DARTS
Huh?

Darts looks down.

Now at the other end of the casino hall, Darts finds himself
with a hand of CARDS at...

INT. VALENTINE'S DIVINE CASINO - POKER TABLE - CONTINUOUS

Roshambo sits eagerly next to Darts.

Four other MEDIOCRE PLAYERS join the table.

Total Players Remaining: 6.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Come, Darts.
(beat)
Show me how dogs play Poker.

DARTS
Roshambo! Report!

Roshambo looks at Darts's CARDS.

ROSHAMBO
BORK!

DARTS
(to Roshambo)
For real? In the first round?
(beat)
I trust you.

Darts shoves a heap of Poker chips into the pot.

DARTS
Fifty-large.

MEDIOCRE PLAYER #4
Fifty-large!?

DARTS
Fifty-large.

MEDIOCRE PLAYER #4
(to Player #3)
Who the hell are they?

MEDIOCRE PLAYER #3
(to Player #4)
Fold.

MEDIOCRE PLAYER #4
What?

MEDIOCRE PLAYER #3
You heard me. Fold.
(beat)
If the dog barks, it's all Darts.
'Least that's what the rumors say.

MEDIOCRE PLAYER #4
Seriously?

Mediocre Player #3 FOLDS.

MEDIOCRE PLAYER #4
Oh, for cryin' out loud...

Mediocre Player #4 FOLDS.

Total Players Remaining: 4.

Darts lights a CIGARETTE.

MEDIOCRE PLAYER #3
It don't fuckin matter what hand
you got. He operates purely off the
dog's vibe. "Roshy: The Dog Who
See's All," they call him.

Darts throws the CIGARETTE at Player #3's FACE.

DARTS
(to Player #3)
No one calls him Roshy but me.

Silence.

Cards FOLD left and right.

Round One ENDS.

Total Players Remaining: 2½.

Darts and Roshambo versus Pachinko Valentine.

BLACK.

INT. DARTS AND QUEEN'S CONDO - BEDROOM - EVENING

BEEP...BEEP...BEEP...BEEP...

...CLICK!

FROM BLACK:

A finger shuts off an alarm clock.

Evening rays peek through the curtains.

All four corners of the room: Elegantly furnished in a clear
and clean white.

CHARLOTTE MARIE QUEEN (Female, 30s) awakens.

She stares at the ceiling.

It stares back.

MONTAGE OF QUEEN'S MORNING ROUTINE

... Queen straightens her hair in the bathroom mirror. Straight, vertical, strokes of the iron. She stares at her hair with an expression that says: "Mistakes will not be tolerated."

... Queen stands in front of her bed. She creases and folds her dove-feather bedsheets to perfection. She's unsatisfied. She's rips the sheets off. She starts again.

... Queen measures coffee grinds into a french press. It registers the weight: 350g Water, 30g Coffee. The optimal 1:12 coffee-to-water ratio. She performs a slow pour into a clear glass mug.

... She polishes old CHESS TROPHIES at the Kitchen Table.

... She walks down the HALLWAY. Old gold medals litter the walls. She takes time to admire each one. She encounters a newspaper on the wall: "Charlotte Marie Queen - A Tragic Defeat." She grows upset. She keeps walking.

END MONTAGE.

INT. DARTS AND QUEEN'S CONDO - LIVING ROOM - CONTINUOUS

Queen enters the room.

A CHESSBOARD rests on an ottoman; collecting dust.

She sits on the couch with her coffee.

Her eyes scan the room.

Cardboard boxes are stacked along the walls. In crudely-written sharpie, they're all labelled: "DARTS AND ROSHY'S STUFF!"

A coffee table stands before her. On top rests UNSIGNED DIVORCE PAPERS...and a half-finished CIGARETTE.

Queen's eyes WIDEN.

She SNATCHES the cigarette and STORMS into the...

INT. DARTS AND QUEEN'S CONDO - GUEST ROOM - CONTINUOUS

A LARGE CRATE covered by a tarp rests in the corner.

Queen approaches it.

She yanks it off.

It's a DOG CAGE...with NO DOG.

QUEEN
Darts!! You motherfu--

INT. VALENTINE'S DIVINE CASINO - POKER TABLE - NIGHT

SLAM!

DARTS
Straight Fuckin' Flush!

Darts and Roshambo's CARDS lie face-up on the Poker table.

The crowd goes WILD.

Valentine shows his cards.

SLAM!

The crowd GASPS.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Royal Flush.

Valentine WINS.

He extends a hand to Darts.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Good game to you, sir.

Darts reluctantly shakes it.

Valentine looks at the chips in the pot.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
An all-in play. A true wildcard.
(beat)
Now then, pay up.

DARTS
Um...uh...

Darts nervously turns to Roshambo.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
(to Darts and Roshambo)
Eyepatch. Scruffy. Money. Now.

Darts puffs out his chest. He approaches Valentine.

DARTS

The money! Of course! I'll just
reeeeeeeach into my pocket and...

His pockets are empty.

DARTS (CONT'D)

...ROSHAMBO, RUUUUUUUUUUUNNNNN!!

The two sprint for the REVOLVING DOORS.

Valentine SNAPS his fingers.

The REVOLVING DOORS LOCK SHUT.

Valentine stares them down.

PACHINKO VALENTINE

(unamused)

That was low.

Darts gazes at the revolving doors.

DARTS

(to Valentine)

How did you--

PACHINKO VALENTINE

I really saw this coming, you know.

(beat)

If you refuse to pay up, I'll just
take something else.

DARTS

Uh, sure?

Valentine raises BOTH HANDS.

SNAP!

Pachinko Valentine's EYES SLIDE OUT from his HEAD.

DARTS

W-W-What?

Roshambo's EYES SLIDE OUT from his HEAD.

DARTS

What!?

Roshambo's EYES SLIDE IN to Valentine's EMPTY EYE-SOCKETS.

DARTS

WHAT!?

Using Roshambo's eyes as his own, Valentine looks around.
 He HOWLS with laughter.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
 Yes! Yes! I feel so free!
 (beat)
 I knew this day would come!

Darts looks to his dog.

Roshambo behaves as he always does...sans-eyeballs.

Blind. Blissful. Unaware.

DARTS
 (to Valentine)
 What did you do to Roshy!?

PACHINKO VALENTINE
 Oh, calm down. The dog is fine.

Valentine holds the DIVINE EYES in his hands.

He stares into them, using Roshambo's eyes.

PACHINKO VALENTINE (CONT'D)
 (to the Divine Eyes)
 Good bloody riddance.

He shoves the Divine Eyes into his POCKET.

He crouches down.

He checks himself out in the floor's reflection.

He feels his own head.

PACHINKO VALENTINE (CONT'D)
 The voices in my head...are gone.
 Everything feels...so quiet now.

Silence.

Valentine revels in the feeling...

...BAM!!

QUEEN (O.S.)
 Darts!

DARTS
 Charlotte!?

ROSHAMBO

BORF!?

Queen stands furiously at the entrance.

MEDIOCRE PLAYER #3

Holy shit, Charlotte Marie Queen!?

MEDIOCRE PLAYER #4

If it isn't the Checkmate Queen herself!

MEDIOCRE PLAYER #3

Haven't heard that name in years.

She STORMS toward Valentine's table.

DARTS

Charlotte, listen! Before you say anything, just breathe with me, alright?

Queen does not breathe with him.

QUEEN

Again?

DARTS

Breeeeeeeeeathe--

QUEEN

With the fucking dog!?

DARTS

He has a name!

QUEEN

You break into the house, you steal away Roshy--

DARTS

Nobody calls him Roshy but me!

QUEEN

Since when?

DARTS

Since you kicked me to the curb and stole my best friend?

QUEEN

You...you--

Queen notices Pachinko Valentine.

QUEEN
(to Valentine)
You!?

Queen stares at Valentine. She recognizes the EYES.

She slowly turns to Roshambo.

She turns pale.

DARTS	PACHINKO VALENTINE
It's not what it looks like!	It's not what it looks like!

QUEEN
I am so through with the both of
you.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Wait, my sweet!

DARTS
My *sweet*!?

PACHINKO VALENTINE
(to Queen)
You said you were divorced!

QUEEN
Going through a divorce!

DARTS
You're banging my wife!?

QUEEN
Ex-wife!

BOOF ! ROSHAMBO

Silence.

QUEEN
(to Valentine)
We were going to have it made,
Valentine. I was prepared to be
everything for you.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
(to Charlotte)
I'm a fucking god, Charlotte. What
did you expect?

QUEEN

I expected you to care about me!

PACHINKO VALENTINE

Oh, did you now? A washed-up chess champ coincidentally finds love in the man who guarantees you victory? You've used me just as much as I've used you.

QUEEN

You stole my dog's eyeballs!

PACHINKO VALENTINE

You only ever want to win. Win, win, win -- always wanting to know what happens next. And I played along...for a while.

DARTS

(to Queen)

...How long is a *while*, Charlotte?

Queen looks down at the floor, ashamed.

DARTS

(to Queen)

Did you ever love us?

Queen remains silent.

Roshambo struggles to walk in a straight line. Blind.

DARTS

Someone better start explaining shit right the fuck now.

PACHINKO VALENTINE

(to Darts)

Listen, boy. I am a god of unknown origin.

(beat)

And I want out.

Darts raises an eyebrow.

PACHINKO VALENTINE (CONT'D)

'Tis no coincidence you've gathered here tonight.

QUEEN

I should have seen this coming.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
 (to Darts)
 As I was saying...

Valentine paces around the room.

He stares at Darts.

PACHINKO VALENTINE (CONT'D)
 My powers can be understood
 through...Pachinko.

Valentine SNAPS his fingers.

POOF!

A PACHINKO PINBALL MACHINE appears.

DARTS
 The hell is this thing?

PACHINKO VALENTINE
 (muttering)
 Someone's never gambled abroad.
 (beat)
 Observe.

Valentine plays the Pachinko Machine over and over.

Rapid-fire pinball gamble!

PACHINKO VALENTINE
 Miss. Miss. Miss. Jackpot. Lucky
 Sevens.

The pinballs fall into the following slots:

Miss. Miss. Miss. JACKPOT.

The Pachinko Machine triggers a SLOTS EVENT.

The SLOTS SPIN around and around...

...LUCKY SEVENS.

DARTS
 You knew.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
 I made it happen. I am aware of all
 timelines.

DARTS
 So you *did* kill Hotshot!

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Perish the thought. I simply knew
how he'd die. Just like I knew
you'd arrive here tonight.

QUEEN
But why?

Roshambo's EYES move around in Valentine's eye-sockets.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
There is nothing more pure than a
dog's loving eyes. And these dog's
are by *far* the purest. The calmest.
The most oblivious. They look
forward to the future without
having to see it, and they've freed
me from my curse.

(beat)
I can't see the timelines anymore.

QUEEN
So you used me!?

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Just. As. You. Used. Me.

Roshambo whimpers.

Darts rubs Roshambo's ears.

DARTS
It's going to be okay, Roshy. I
promise.

QUEEN
I've had enough of this.

Queen pushes Darts out of the way.

She takes hold of Roshambo.

Roshambo resists.

QUEEN (CONT'D)
(to Darts)
I'll be taking the dog.

She turns to Valentine.

QUEEN (CONT'D)
(To Valentine)
I'll be taking back those eyes.

QUEEN (CONT'D)
(to Darts)
And for god's sake, promise me
you'll sign these.

Queen pulls out the UNSIGNED DIVORCE PAPERS.

Darts crudely folds the papers and pockets them.

DARTS
I promise you'll never take Roshy
from me.

QUEEN
We'll see what DPS has to say about
that.

DARTS
DPS?

QUEEN
Dog Protective Services.

DARTS
What!?

QUEEN
That's right.

DARTS
You just made that up!

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Bold of you to assume you can just
waltz out my doors.

Valentine looks to Darts.

PACHINKO VALENTINE (CONT'D)
Between the dishevelled dirtbag who
puts his dog in harm's way...

Valentine looks to Queen.

PACHINKO VALENTINE (CONT'D)
...And the insufferable prude who
just wants to win...

Valentine sighs.

PACHINKO VALENTINE (CONT'D)
I ought to take the dog for myself.

The room is speechless.

PACHINKO VALENTINE (CONT'D)
 However, I'm feeling rather
 generous this evening. Let's settle
 this with a game, shall we?

QUEEN
 The same kind of game that killed
 Hotshot? I think not.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
 You *could* settle things in divorce
 court, but where's the fun in that?
 Perhaps a wager is in order
 instead.

QUEEN
 You can't make me play.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
 You're right. I can't. That's not
 how my contracts work.

Valentine SNAPS his fingers.

POOF!

A floating CONTRACT and a floating PEN appear.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
 For a game like this, the two of
 you must sign.

DARTS
 I didn't sign up for Roshy's
 eyeballs to be taken!

PACHINKO VALENTINE
 But you agreed to the gamble.
 Contracts can be informal, verbal,
 written, symbolic, you name it. As
 long as the parties want to play,
 the game shall commence.

QUEEN
 This is utter nonsense.

DARTS
 Roshy, what do you wanna do?

Roshambo looks at Darts with his empty eyes.

He hides behind Darts.

He stares at Valentine.

Darts notices.

DARTS
We're in.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
(to Queen)
And you?

QUEEN
I'll see you in court, Darts.

Queen walks away with Roshambo.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
(to Queen)
Hard to win over the jury if an
eyeless mutt takes the stand.

Queen HALTS.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
What would Dog Protective Services
say?

QUEEN
You know what? Fine.

Darts and Queen sign Valentine's CONTRACT.

QUEEN
What are your terms?

PACHINKO VALENTINE
No, my dear. What are yours?

Valentine SNAPS his fingers.

POOF!

An arrangement of FIVE FLOATING BUTTONS appear, labelled:

"10, 20, 50, 100, and MAX BET."

PACHINKO VALENTINE (CONT'D)
What are you willing to risk for
your happy ending?

Queen rolls her eyes.

She reaches for the "10" BUTTON.

Darts GRABS Queen's HAND...

QUEEN
Agh!! What are you--

...and SLAMS the MAX BET BUTTON.

QUEEN
NO! I DEMAND--

PACHINKO VALENTINE
The players have chosen.

Valentine SNAPS his fingers.

POOF!

The entire venue transforms into...

INT. VALENTINE'S CASINO - BATTLE COLLESEUM - CONTINUOUS

Darts and Queen face off.

Lights FLASH.

The crowd ROARS in the stands.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
(to the Crowd)
Gooooooooooooo evening, everyone!
Welcome to the main event! You all
know why we're here! Say it with
me, folks: It's time for...

CROWD
(in unison)
...Rock, Paper, Scissors...To the
DEATH!

The crowd goes WILD.

QUEEN
I-I demand a do-over!

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Nay. Make your moves.

The crowd GASPS.

PACHINKO VALENTINE (CONT'D)
The winner leaves with Roshambo and
their life.
(beat)
The loser shall violently perish.

A pause.

QUEEN
And if we tie?

PACHINKO VALENTINE
The eyes will pop out of my head,
and I shall burn to ash.

DARTS
You'd really let that happen?

PACHINKO VALENTINE
No fun in the gamble without risks
of my own.

DARTS
But you already know what's gonna
happen!

PACHINKO VALENTINE
(pointing to his eyes)
Not anymore.

QUEEN
The next move is clear, then.
(to Darts)
Darts, promise me.

DARTS
Huh?

QUEEN
Promise me you'll tie.

DARTS
(smugly)
Oh-ho...Oh-ho-ho-ho!
(to the Crowd)
This cheating bitch wants to make
more promises!

CROWD
BOOOOOOOOOO!

QUEEN
(to the Crowd)
Oh. My. God. We are going through a
divorce!

DARTS
(to the Crowd)
That's funny...

Darts holds up the UNSIGNED DIVORCE PAPERS to the crowd.

DARTS (CONT'D)
...Cause *I* haven't signed a god-damn thing!

CROWD
BOOOOOOOOOO!

PACHINKO VALENTINE
(to the Crowd)
Oh, the drama!

DARTS
And I won't need to sign, either.
(beat)
This ends tonight.

QUEEN
You're really going to kill me!?

DARTS
You didn't just use Valentine.
(beat)
You used me and Roshy, too.

QUEEN
How dare you accuse me of such an act?

DARTS
For years, me and Roshy were winning big. But as soon as our luck turned sour this year...Bam. The papers.

QUEEN
I-I--

DARTS
And what do you do? You get busy with this clown!

Darts points to Valentine.

CROWD
OOOOOHH!

Valentine is unamused.

QUEEN
Only after you gambled everything we had away!

DARTS

Everything we had? That was all me
and Roshy! Face it. As long as you
stay rich and winning, you'll fuck
any poser under the sun!

Darts raises his FIST.

DARTS (CONT'D)

Let's dance.

The crowd is PUMPED.

CROWD

(chanting)

Play! Play! Play! Play!

QUEEN

(to Darts)

Fine. You *really* wanna go?

CROWD

(chanting)

Play! Play! Play! Play!

Queen raises her FIST.

QUEEN

Say your prayers, worm.

CROWD

OHOOOOOOOOH!

DARTS

Roshambo! What's our move?

ROSHAMBO

BORK!

Darts nods his head.

PACHINKO VALENTINE

Let the games begin!

DARTS

Rock, Paper, Scissors!

QUEEN

Rock, Paper, Scissors, Shoot!

Silence.

Darts chooses ROCK.

Queen chooses PAPER.

Slience.

QUEEN
...Are you fucking kidding me?

DARTS
What?

QUEEN
You go on scissors?

DARTS
Everybody goes on scissors!

QUEEN
Bull. Shit--

DARTS
You wanna talk bullshit? I just
lost everything over this!

Roshambo PANICS.

ROSHAMBO
BORF! BORF! BORF! BORF!

PACHINKO VALENTINE
(to Roshambo)
Oh, put a sock in it.

Pachinko Valentine takes an impatiently deep breath.

PACHINKO VALENTINE (CONT'D)
For god's sake...both opponents
must play their hands at the same
time.

Darts and Queen stare at each other.

DARTS
We're starting on scissors.

QUEEN
We're starting on shoot!

PACHINKO VALENTINE
(under his breath)
For the love of...
(to the Crowd)
...Looks like it's time for a bonus
round, folks!

DARTS
Bonus round!!

QUEEN
Bonus round!?

PACHINKO VALENTINE
 (to the Crowd)
 A mini-game! An extra dose of fun!
 (muttering)
 Something to get you two on the
 same bloody page--

DARTS
 Ooh! Ooh! I got an idea!

Darts turns to Queen.

DARTS
 One without this two-timer
 involved.
 (to Valentine)
 Gimme the slots, baby!

QUEEN
 W-w-wait! No! I demand an
 alternative resolution--

PACHINKO VALENTINE
 (to Darts)
 I like it.

Valentine SNAPS his fingers.

POOF!

A shiny and vibrant SLOT MACHINE appears.

Darts stands before it.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
 Look. If you can land all Lucky
 Sevens within three spins, Rock
 Paper Scissors will begin on
scissors.
 (beat)
 If you do not, the game begins on
shoot.

DARTS
 (to Roshambo)
 You feelin' hot, Roshy?

ROSHAMBO
 BORK!

QUEEN
 (to Darts and Roshambo)
 Gamblers...They truly can't be
 saved.

DARTS
Gambling is what saved us!

Darts PULLS THE LEVER.

The SLOTS SPIN.

RESULT #1: Watermelon. Watermelon. Seven.

CROWD
OHH!!

Roshambo whines.

Darts shakes it off.

He PULLS THE LEVER AGAIN.

The SLOTS SPIN.

RESULT #2: Bell. Banana. Banana.

CROWD
Oooh...

Roshambo hangs his head in shame.

DARTS
Be strong, Roshy! We got this!

The final round.

Darts PULLS THE LEVER.

The SLOTS SPIN.

RESULT #3: Seven...Seven...SEVEN.

DARTS	QUEEN
YEAAAAAAHHH!!	NOOOOOOOOOO!!

The crowd goes WILD.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
(to the Crowd)
The results are in!
(beat)
The game shall commence on
scissors!
(beat)
Now get on with it already.

QUEEN
No matter. I still refuse to lose.
(MORE)

QUEEN (CONT'D)
 (beat)
 I'll see you in hell, Darts!

DARTS
 Bring it on you crusty bitch!

Roshambo hides his face.

He whimpers.

Darts crouches down next to him.

DARTS
 What's the matter, Roshy? You won
 us the match!

Roshambo whines.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
 Get. On. With. It.

Darts takes one last look at Roshambo.

He turns to Queen.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
 (to the Crowd)
 This is it, folks!

They raise their FISTS.

PACHINKO VALENTINE (CONT'D)
 (to the Crowd)
 It's time for...

DARTS
 Rock! Paper! Sci--

QUEEN
 Rock! Paper! Sci--

CHOMP!

PACHINKO VALENTINE
 AAAGH!!

Roshambo steals the DIVINE EYES from Valentine's POCKET.

He SPRINTS toward Darts.

DARTS
 Roshy! What are you doing?!

ROSHAMBO
 (muffled)
 MRRF!!

Roshambo drops the DIVINE EYES at Dart's feet.

He looks up at his owner.

ROSHAMBO

Borf.

DARTS

You really want to win...Like this?

ROSHAMBO

Borf.

DARTS

Roshy...I've always known you
aren't "The Dog Who Sees All."

The crowd GASPS.

DARTS (CONT'D)

(to Roshambo)

And you don't need to be.

QUEEN

B-B-But the Scratch n' Sniff! The
Poker!? It was all a fluke!?

DARTS

What can I say?

(beat)

Me and Roshy are a lucky pair.

Darts TAKES the DIVINE EYES...

PACHINKO VALENTINE

Wait! Are you seriously going to--

...And SHOVES THEM INTO ROSHAMBO'S EYE-SOCKETS.

ROSHAMBO

AWOOOOOOOOOOOOOO!!

An AURA OF POWER shines around Roshambo.

The DIVINE EYES spin rapidly like a slot machine in
Roshambo's head.

ROSHAMBO

(distressed)

ARF! ARF! ARF!

Roshambo PANICS.

ROSHAMBO

YELP!

Roshambo is SHAKING.

DARTS

Roshy!? What's wrong!? Say something!!

PACHINKO VALENTINE

It is too late. The dog will now learn the price of foresight.

ROSHAMBO

AWOOOOOOOO--

WHITE.

EXT. PARK - FLASHBACK - NIGHT

FROM WHITE:

Darts is alone.

He spins drunkenly on a children's merry-go-round.

He's on top of the world.

He falls off.

He dusts off the playground woodchips from his coat.

He stumbles through the park toward the exit.

He drunkenly waltzs across an empty street.

He sits on the sidewalk.

He lays against the walls of a LOTTO VENDOR.

His smile fades.

He dozes off.

EXT. PARK - FLASHBACK - NEXT DAY

Darts awakens.

He looks like shit. He's starving.

Cityfolk pass him by, as if he wasn't there.

He digs for loose change in his coat pockets.

Nothing.

A passerby flicks a single-cent PENNY at Darts' HEAD.

He holds the PENNY in his hand.

He stares at it.

SCRUMBLE...SCRUMBLE...SCRUMBLE...

Darts hears something down the alleyway.

He follows the sound.

He encounters a DUMPSTER. It RATTLES. It SHAKES.

He slowly opens the LID.

It's a PUPPY - Tattered. Thin. Scared.

Roshambo.

He looks up at Darts, holding something his mouth.

A LOTTO TICKET.

Darts carefully takes it from Roshambo.

He inspects it:

"MR. HOTSHOT'S SCRATCH N' SNIFF BONANZA!"

"If you smell the pizza, fortune greets ya!"

The ticket is only half scratched-out.

ROSHAMBO
(muffled)
Arrf.

Darts leans against the dumpster. He scratches away.

Roshambo pops up from behind. He watches.

The entire lotto ticket is scratched out.

Darts hesitates to sniff.

He gently holds out the lotto ticket to Roshambo's NOSE.

SNIFF...SNIFF...

ROSHAMBO
AWOOOOOOOOOOO!!

Darts sniffs the ticket.

They look at each other.

Their eyes light up.

Jackpot.

EXT. PARK - FLASHBACK - DAY

Darts takes Roshambo for a walk in the park.

Darts spots a woman at a picnic table.

ROSHAMBO

BORK!

He pulls out a COIN in front of her.

He tosses it into the air.

QUEEN

Heads.

The coin strikes the ground.

TAILS.

Queen concedes her loss.

Darts extends his hand. He's won himself a date.

INT. HOTSHOT'S VILE VEGAS CASINO - FLASHBACK - NIGHT

Darts spins the SLOTS with Roshambo over and over.

He loses the rest of his lottery winnings.

INT. DARTS AND QUEEN'S CONDO - FLASHBACK - NIGHT

KITCHEN

Darts sits alone at the table; divorce papers before him.

INT. VALENTINE'S CASINO - BATTLE COLLESEUM - NIGHT

Valentine's AURA OF POWER weakens.

Valentine is taken aback.

A smile grows on his face.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Shoving the Divine Eyes in your own
dog.

(beat)
Can't say I saw that coming.

Valentine's POWERS drain from his body.

PACHINKO VALENTINE (CONT'D)
If the divine eyes leave my
proximity...my powers fade. But
that is okay.

Roshambo's Divine Eyes FLASH wildly.

QUEEN
He can't use the eyes! That's not
fair--

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Gamblers don't concern themselves
with fairness. The game shall go
on!

Roshambo struggles under the power of the DIVINE EYES.

DARTS
Roshy! What move!? Hurry!

Roshambo fails to respond.

Silence.

DARTS (CONT'D)
(under his breath)
It's okay, Roshy.
(beat)
I got this.

Roshambo is losing BALANCE.

DARTS
(to Queen)
Charlotte! Play me!

QUEEN
Promise me! Promise me you'll--

DARTS
Yup.

Darts takes out the UNSIGNED DIVORCE PAPERS.

He signs them.

He THROWS them at QUEEN.

DARTS
A promise is a promise.

Darts and Queen angrily raise their FISTS.

The game begins.

DARTS	QUEEN
Rock, Paper, Scissors!!	Rock, Paper, Scissors!!

Queen chooses SCISSORS.

Darts chooses ROCK.

Silence.

Queen stares at the ceiling.

A GIGANTIC FIST-SHAPED ROCK SMASHES THROUGH THE ROOF.

Queen gazes upward at it. Emotionless.

QUEEN
(to Herself)
All I ever wanted was to live my
best life.
(beat)
Was that really so much to ask?

SPLURTCH!!

QUEEN is DEAD. Shattered into a million pieces.

The collesium slowly fades away...

INT. VALENTINE'S DIVINE CASINO - CONTINUOUS

The casino is empty.

The crowd is gone.

Through the smoke, Darts calls out for...

DARTS
Roshy! Where are you!?

Darts looks around in a panic.

DARTS
Roshy!!

Darts spots Roshambo in the corner of the room.

A shaky Roshambo winces and whimpers under the influence of the Divine Eyes.

DARTS
I'm coming!

Darts runs over to Roshambo.

He stares into Roshambo's DIVINE EYES.

DARTS
I've got you. I'm here.

Darts REMOVES BOTH of the DIVINE EYES from Roshambo's HEAD.

Roshambo is blind once again.

He stops shaking.

Darts holds Roshambo in his arms.

DARTS
You're safe...You're safe.

PACHINKO VALENTINE (O.S.)
Is he?

Darts turns around.

Through the smoke, he appears: Pachinko Valentine LIVES.

He stares at Darts using Roshambo's eyes.

DARTS
With that self-absorbed bitch and
your powers gone for good, you bet
your ass he's safe.

PACHINKO VALENTINE
Safe from me? Naturally.
(beat)
But is he safe from you?

Darts holds the Divine Eyes in his hands.

DARTS
(to Valentine)
Of course he is...

Darts RIPS OFF his EYE-PATCH.

DARTS (CONT'D)
(to Valentine)
...But you're not.

Darts shoves a DIVINE EYE into his own empty EYE-SOCKET.

DARTS
UAAAAAAAAAGH!!

An AURA OF POWER shines around him.

He struggles to point a finger at Valentine.

DARTS
(to Valentine)
Y-Y-You're gonna...give me back
his...AGHH!!

PACHINKO VALENTINE
You see it now, do you not? The
curse of the clairvoyant. A hell
you wouldn't wish on anyone. Thus,
I beg of you.
(beat)
Please don't take my peace from me.

Darts prepares to snap his fingers.

DARTS
You're gonna pay for what you've
done!

Darts SNAP--

ROSHAMBO
BORK!

Darts STOPS.

He looks down to Roshambo.

Roshambo stares up at Darts.

DARTS
B-But Roshy...Your eyes...We--

ROSHAMBO
Borf.

Roshambo picks up the EYE-PATCH with his mouth.

He looks back up at Darts.

DARTS
I...I...RAHHHHH!!

Darts RIPS the DIVINE EYE out of his socket.

He holds up BOTH DIVINE EYES in his HANDS.

He turns the eyes towards eachother...

...**KABOOM!!**

THE DIVINE EYES SPLATTER ACROSS THE CASINO HALL.

Valentine's jaw drops.

PACHINKO VALENTINE

(To Darts)

The eyes of a god; squandered by
man. This is...quite the surprise.

(to himself)

So *that's* what those feel like.

(to Darts)

Boy, tell me! Is this why you
gamble!?

Darts and Roshambo turn away from Valentine.

They make way for the LOCKED REVOLVING DOORS.

PACHINKO VALENTINE

W-Wait!

Darts and Roshambo halt.

PACHINKO VALENTINE

To have this feeling...Is all I've
ever wanted. Thus...

Valentine reaches into his pocket.

PACHINKO VALENTINE (CONT'D)

...Surprise, top-dog.

Valentine tosses Darts the CASINO KEYS.

Darts is taken aback.

He looks down at the keys in his hands.

PACHINKO VALENTINE

Chase that feeling until the end of
time.

Darts looks back up...

...Valentine is gone.

Darts and Roshambo walk to the entrance.

He shoves the key in the LOCK.

They push through the revolving doors.

MATCH CUT TO:

EXT. LUCKY PAW CASINO - PARKING LOT - NIGHT

The parking lot is FULL.

Neon lights twinkle beneath the sky.

Above the casino's entrance, a LARGE SIGN:

A graphic of Darts and Roshambo playing cards together.

They look happy.

FADE OUT.